

Resident Advisor Duty

Resident Advisor Duty Rotation and Schedule

All information below is general and may change according to the needs of your community.

- **Duty Schedule:**
 - Each community has RA(s) on duty from 4:30 pm – 8:00 am during regular periods and 8:00 pm – 8:00 am during break periods.
 - Regular and break period are determined by Residence Life & your CD/GSA will let you know when duty will begin at 8:00 pm; assume the start is at 4:30 pm unless otherwise stated.
 - Duty is scheduled in a rotation with others on your immediate team.
 - Scheduling and rotation is determined by your CD/GSA.
 - All buildings or areas are to have at least one RA on duty every evening
- **Beginning of the Year:**
 - FY communities have two RAs on duty on Fridays and Saturdays. During the first weeks of the school year, increased duty coverage may be necessary in all communities.
 - CD/GSAs will be responsible for determining the needed duty & RA presence level for their communities
- **Scheduling:**
 - The CD/GSA is responsible for coordinating the duty schedule for their community.
 - The duty schedule must be updated in Roomcompact.
 - Refer to your CD/GSA for more information regarding these procedures.

Duty Schedule Changes

- If you are changing a duty assignment with another RA, it must be changed in Roomcompact and approved by the CD/GSA.

Responsibilities When Beginning Duty

- Pick up duty phone (see Resident Advisor Duty Phones for more information).
- Check in: Check in with the CD/GSA on-duty by texting from your community's duty phone. Check in should not occur more than 10 minutes prior to start of 4:30 or 8 pm duty shift.
- Where applicable, place your name card in the areas designated in the building so all students know who to contact if they need something.

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Building/Community Walks

- Building/Community Walks should occur several times through the evening, and it is recommended that you stagger community walks occasionally – generally these will occur around 8:00 pm, 10:00 pm, 12:00 am and 2:00 am (2:00 am only on weekends).
- At the start of each Building/Community Walk, RAs will spend the first 15 minutes being present in a common area of the building. This may include a front desk, lobby, or common meeting place for students.
- Building/Community Walks are not meant to be a quick walk through the building but done so with intention and integrity. RAs should take time to build relationships with students while also monitoring the safety and security of the community.
- Building/Community Walks help ensure the safety and security of all residents:

RA Checks For	Response
Any noisy areas, concerning activity, policy violations	• Address concerning room or people (knock on door or approach people involved) • Call Public Safety for assistance as needed • Document noise complaints in duty log • Document other policy violations via Advocate
All exterior entrances are locked and secure as expected	• Call Public Safety to resecure any doors • Public Safety may call Facilities for assistance
Any unescorted guests	• If violating policy, follow response procedures • If not actively violating policy other than being unescorted, politely ask them to leave the building • Call Public Safety for any assistance
All common areas (i.e., bathrooms, lounges, study rooms, elevators, stairs, lobbies, etc.) are free of messes, vandalism, and damage and all furniture is present	• Take photos • Call Public Safety • Document via Advocate • Email your CD/GSA the photos • Submit an RFS as appropriate
Ovens and stovetops in kitchens are off	• Turn off if no resident is present • Call Public Safety for any fire concerns
Laundry machines are working properly	• Submit a work order via CSC app
All fire extinguishers are present	• Call Public Safety • Document via Advocate
All spaces (including resident doors) are free of damage and vandalism	• Take photos • Call Public Safety • Document via Advocate • Email your CD/GSA the photos

- Final community walks should be done around 12:00 am Sunday – Thursday and 2:00 am on Fridays and Saturdays.
- Community walks are also a great time to stop by and visit with residents, especially those who don't live on your floor. Make a special effort to get to know more people.
- **Documentation:** Be sure to document your community walks and other information in the duty log form in Roomcompact. If anything occurs while on duty (i.e., fire alarm, you submit a

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Request for Service, an incident is documented, etc.) be sure to also note this in your duty log. Submit duty log after completing last set of community walks

- **Availability:** Take the opportunity of being on duty to spend time with the residents. It can be a great time to reach out as a RA. Treat your duty community walks as an opportunity to get to know residents within your building or area.
 - Keep your door open, if possible. Students are more likely to come to you if you seem approachable. If your door must be closed, put up a sign saying, “On Duty, Please knock” or where you are within the building.
 - **Do not leave the building.** You may have friends over while on duty; just make it known to them that you may be called to respond to an incident, or a resident could stop by your room. It's possible your guests will need to leave immediately.
 - You must always be ready to respond while on duty.
 - You may be called to respond to incidents throughout the night. Please make sure that the duty cell phone is kept at a volume that would wake you.

RESIDENT ADVISOR DUTY CELL PHONES

Resident Advisors (RAs) will use their building/area's duty cell phone to communicate with Public Safety and the CD/GSA on duty, and each other. These phones are only to be used for duty purposes, not personal communication or entertainment. RAs will be responsible for taking care of these phones appropriately. Data is not to be used unless there is an emergency and Wi-Fi is not available. RAs will not download apps without approval from CD/GSA.

Protocol

RA on duty will:

1. Pick up the duty cell phone from designated location in each building/area by 4:30 p.m.
2. Text the CD/GSA duty phone with their name to check in by 4:30 pm.
 - a. Check in cannot occur more than 10 minutes prior to the start of the duty shift (i.e., no earlier than 4:20 p.m. or 7:50 p.m.)
3. Always keep the phone on their person
4. Always answer phone:
 - a. Begin call with: "Community Name RA on duty, this is NAME"
 - b. If a call is missed for any reason, the RA:
 - i. Listens to the voicemail (if applicable)
 - ii. Returns the phone call immediately
5. **Always leave the ringer on HIGH** and will never turn it to silent or vibrate.
6. Charge the phone if necessary while the phone is in their possession.
7. Return the duty cell phone to the designated location in their building by 10:00 a.m. the following morning and plug the phone in to be charged.
8. Report any damages or malfunctions with the duty phone to their CD/GSA, who will then inform the Associate Director.
9. Notify and provide Public Safety, CD/GSA on duty, and the Desk staff (as applicable) with their room phone number or contact information should the duty cell phone stop functioning.

RA Duty Check-In Protocol / Follow Up

1. Check ins must occur by 4:30 pm (or 8:00 pm when designated).
 - a. Check in may not occur more than ten minutes prior to the designated check in time (i.e., no earlier than 4:20 pm or 7:50 pm)
 - b. If a RA checks in early, the CD/GSA will respond asking them to check back in at the appropriate time.
2. If the RA does not check in on the duty phone within 5 minutes, the CD/GSA on duty will text that hall's duty phone
3. If there is no response from the duty phone within 10 minutes of the designated duty start time, the CD/GSA on duty will (in order):
 - a. Call the hall duty phone.
 - b. If no answer, check to see who is on duty and call that RA's personal cell phone and/or room phone.
 - c. If no answer, physically go to the hall to check for the student at their desk and their room.
4. Once the RA misses the 5-minute grace period, their supervisor will be notified, along with how long it took to get a hold of them.
5. RAs must be physically present in their hall with duty phone by start of duty.

RESIDENT ADVISOR DUTY CELL PHONES

- a. If they have class that goes beyond the start of duty, someone else needs to be covering (i.e., class goes until 5 pm, so someone holds the phone from 4:30 – 5 pm).
- b. Check in text should happen both from the person at start of duty and from anyone who takes the phone afterward.

Duty Phone Numbers Posted:

- Duty cell phone numbers will be posted in the respective community along with the times the phone will be answered.
- Residents may call the cell phone for lock outs, noise concerns, or other issues/questions.
- If a resident calls to report an emergency, the RA on duty will encourage resident to call PS Emergency Line and will initiate emergency protocols.
- If a resident calls to prank a duty cell phone:
 - If it is a singular call, the RA will make note of the phone number and any additional information and include it in the duty log for the CD/GSA; CD/GSA will determine if Public Safety needs to be alerted
 - If the calls are persistent, the RA should call Public Safety to attempt to figure out the identity of the caller

Protocol for Public Safety:

- Between 4:30 pm – 8:00 am
 - Call RA duty phone
 - If the call is unanswered, call the CD/GSA on duty
- Between 8:00 am – 4:30 pm
 - Call the CD/GSA on duty

Duty Contact Information

Public Safety

- Emergency: 651-962-5555 (2-5555 from an on-campus phone)
- Non-Emergency: 651-962-5100 (2-5100 from an on-campus phone)

CD/GSA Duty Phone: 612-801-8484

- Do NOT provide this number to residents, parents, etc. It is ONLY to be used by Residence Life team members.

RA Duty Cell Phone Numbers:

Brady: 651-675-8603

Dowling: 651-675-8487

Flynn: 651-675-8583

Frey: 763-406-1343

Grace: 651-675-8636

Ireland: 651-675-8663

Mid-Campus: 651-675-8525

Morrison: 651-675-8587

Murray: 651-675-8544

Tommie North: 763-406-1403

STUDENT LEADER EMERGENCY CALLING PROTOCOL

BOLD text indicates who you should call first in every situation.

This chart provides a guideline for when to call in various circumstances. If you find yourself in a situation that isn't on the list and you need assistance, please don't hesitate to call the CD/GSA on duty. If you aren't sure if you should be calling – always call. It's better to over report than under report.

***When/if a student is sent to the care room after Public Safety's assessment, please contact the CD/GSA on duty.**

Incident Type	Call CD/GSA on Duty 612-801-8484	Call Public Safety 651-962-5100 (non-emergency calls) 651-962-5555 (emergency calls)
Accidents not requiring hospital transport	NO	YES
Acts of Intolerance/Bias/Harassment/ Hate Crime	YES	YES
Alcohol or Drug Violation	NO	YES
Death of a Student	YES	YES
Fireworks or other Fire Hazards	NO	YES
Flood in Hall	YES	YES
Noise Violation	NO	NO
Physical Assault	YES	YES
Pulled Fire Alarm	NO	YES
Real Fire Emergency	YES	YES
Room/Building Search when community safety is at risk	YES	YES (Only PS can conduct searches)
Room/Building Search to find alcohol/drugs or guests	NO	YES (Only PS can conduct searches)
Serious Mental Health Concerns	YES	YES (CD/GSA will likely call)
Serious Vandalism (Extensive damage, broken windows)	YES	YES
Sexual Misconduct	YES	NO (CD/GSA on duty will contact PS if requested)
Student Arrest	YES	YES
Student Emergency Transport to Hospital	YES	YES
Student Requiring Attention in CARE Room	YES	YES (although they're likely already there)
Emergency Personnel in Community (i.e., Police, EMTs, Fire)	YES	YES (although they're likely already there)
Suicide Attempt/Gesture	YES	YES
Theft	NO	YES
Unconscious Student	YES	YES
Unresponsive Intoxicated/Impaired Student	NO	YES
Unusual Facilities Incidents	YES	YES
Visitation Violation	NO	NO
Weapons	NO	YES

Alcohol Related Incidents – RA Response

Policy Violation Observed	Student Leader Responses
Alcohol possessed (even in sealed container) or consumed at any location by an underage student. Open container possessed or consumed in hallway or other public area by any person, regardless of age. Alcohol served or sold (distributed) to underage person by legal age person. Open alcohol possessed or consumed outside (i.e., Flynn/Morrison patio, outside Koch commons), near hall by any person. Possession of large volumes of alcohol, which includes but is not limited to kegs, party balls, punch bowl, or other container indicative of large amount of alcohol in residence hall by any person. Alcohol consumption by an apartment resident of legal age in a residential space while a guest that is underage is present.	Call Public Safety and request their presence. Advise persons that they are in violation of University policy. Gather student ID information for use while report writing. Document Public Safety's interaction with students. Public Safety will have residents dispose of alcohol (drain into toilet or sink) if against policy. Submit a report in Advocate.
Empty alcohol containers are found in a room/suite/apartment with at least one underage resident (usually only occurs during health & safety checks when residents are not present).	Dispose of containers in a common area with the student, your duty partner, or Public Safety. Submit a report in Advocate.

Alcohol Related Incidents – RA Response

Residents of Room / Suite / Apt.	Policy
No resident of the room is of legal drinking age.	Students under the age of 21 are not allowed to possess or consume alcohol on campus in accordance with the Student Policy Book and Federal and State Laws. No parties or activities may be held with alcohol present. No alcohol may be stored in the room.
At least one resident of the room/suite/apartment is of legal drinking age, but at least one resident is underage.	In situations where there are residents of legal drinking age and those not of legal drinking age are assigned to the same room or apartment, those who are 21 and over can have alcohol in their room or apartment but cannot provide alcohol to their underage roommates. If there is a question of possession, ownership or providing, the situation will be documented and addressed through the student conduct process. We advise that students of legal drinking age who choose to have alcohol in their room/apartment/unit, store/keep the alcohol in their bedroom and in their individual mini refrigerator if applicable. Only guests of legal age are allowed in the room or apartment when alcohol is being served. Large volumes of alcohol, which includes but is not limited to kegs, party balls, multiple cases of beer, wine, and multiple bottles of hard liquor, are not allowed in the Residence Halls.

Alcohol Related Incidents – RA Response

Alcohol Policy Confrontation Tips

- If you observe any items or individual behaviors that indicate students have been drinking (alcohol containers, shot glasses, slurred speech, impaired motor skills, smells of alcohol, etc.), and know at least one resident to be under the age of 21, call Public Safety.
- If you observe any individuals who display signs of significant impairment, or you are concerned for their wellbeing, contact Public Safety. This applies to all students regardless of age.
- Collect ID information from students (first and last name, ID number). Explain to the students that you are documenting the situation and behaviors.
- Scan the room for other alcohol in plain view and make note for documentation and report writing.
- Public Safety will ask residents to disclose all alcohol or substances present in the space. They may choose to conduct a search for additional alcohol or substances.
- Note the amount and type of alcohol involved in the situation.
 - Ex: 1.75 Liter of Sky Watermelon Vodka, approximately ½ full.
 - You may include how much residents had to drink should they disclose this information to you or Public Safety.
- Public Safety will dispose of any alcohol.
- If at any point you feel unsafe during an incident, leave the scene and wait nearby for Public Safety to arrive. In extreme situations, if you leave the area or building entirely, contact Public Safety and update them on your location. In situations where you feel unsafe or concerned about the behavior of residents, you may also contact the CD/GSA on-duty for guidance. Contacting Public Safety first is preferred, when possible.

Alcohol Related Incidents – RA Response

Intoxicated Student Intervention

When you encounter an obviously impaired student, one of our primary concerns is the health of the student and the possible risks the student may pose to themselves and others. If, in your judgment, the health of this or other students is in danger, please use the following procedure to ensure the best possible outcome.

- Contact Public Safety immediately and report locations of incident and identifying information about student. This may include what they are wearing, approximate height, hair color, etc. You may also include the behaviors you have noticed.
- Assess the situation: What are the important details? Is the student unable to walk normally, slurring speech? Do you notice any obvious injury (cuts, scrapes)? Is there a noticeable odor?
- Monitor physical symptoms. This may include changes in their skin color or breathing, vomiting, or if the student becomes unconscious.
- If paramedics are called, please make room for Public Safety and responding medics/officers to complete their work. This may include waiting in the hallway.
- Public safety will notify the CD/GSA on duty if students are transported off campus.
- If the student is not being transported, Public Safety will make a decision regarding where that student will go for the night (with a family member, etc.) Student Leaders are not allowed to watch/monitor/stay with a student.
- Document the incident thoroughly via Advocate.
- The CD/GSA may ask the student leader to follow up with a student when they return to campus.

Err on the side of caution, notify the CD/GSA if you are uncertain of how to respond.

RA RESPONSE PROCEDURES

THC or Other Drugs

- Refer to the Code of Conduct and the Resident Student Handbook for relevant policies.
- If you suspect the use of THC or other drugs, **immediately contact Public Safety**.
- Public Safety will address the residence and determine the presence of illegal substances.
- Follow the instructions of Public Safety.
- **Never handle illegal substances.**
- Document the situation in Advocate.
- Notify the CD/GSA on duty if St. Paul Police Department (SPPD) is called in.

General Illness / Medical Concerns

Residence Life student leaders should **never** provide transportation for an injured or ill resident (no matter how minor the situation may seem). Residence Life student leaders **should never** offer medical care, including offering bandages or over-the-counter medications. RAs are not trained nor provided protection for handling bodily fluids or any other medical care. Students will need to provide their own medical care or contact Public Safety. Public Safety can provide minimal medical assessment and can contact Saint Paul Emergency Response to meet with students on-campus.

Medical Emergencies

If the student is unresponsive, student leaders should **not** move or shake the student.

- In the event of a medical emergency call Public Safety's Emergency line:
 - 651-962-5555
- Public safety will determine next steps.
- Notify the CD/GSA on duty.
- Document the situation in Advocate.

Physical Assault

Under no circumstances are student leaders or Residence Life team members to physically "break up" a fight. It is not your responsibility to do so. You need to take care of yourself. Remember that all people have the potential for fighting. The circumstances should not differ between gender and situations. Reassure victims they make all decisions in the process.

In the event that a physical fight breaks out:

- Call Public Safety and request that an officer respond immediately.
- Contact the CD/GSA to inform them of the situation.
- Document the situation in Advocate.

RA RESPONSE PROCEDURES

Death of a Student

- **Immediately** contact Public Safety and then CD/GSA on duty.
- Do not attempt to notify the student's parents/guardians, and do not release any information about the situation or the deceased to students, friends, family, media, etc. This includes St. Thomas affiliated media.
- It is vital that you take care of yourself. Please utilize all campus resources during and after stressful or tragic incidents.

Sexual Misconduct

- Refer to the Title IX policy and the Title IX website for resources.
- Explain to the reporting party that while you are **required to report** this to a CD/GSA, the information will be kept within our mandatory reporting structure.
- **Immediately** contact the CD/GSA on duty.
- The CD/GSA on duty will offer resources and work with the student to ensure their immediate needs are met.
- You must submit the Title IX Reporting Form (CD/GSA on Duty will assist).
- Do not document the situation in Advocate or Roompack.
- Your CD/GSA may ask you to follow up with additional support.

Mental Health Concerns (including suicidal ideation)

- If the student is indicating mental health concerns, call the CD/GSA on Duty
- If the student needs immediate medical attention, notify Public Safety, then the CD/GSA on-duty.
- Document in Advocate.

Missing Student

- Contact Public Safety.
- **Do not attempt to release information or notify the missing student's parents or guardians.**
- Document the situation in Advocate.

Bomb Threats

- If you are notified directly of a Bomb Threat (via phone call, e-mail, etc.), **contact Public Safety immediately.**

Fire Preparation and Prevention

- Fire safety and prevention must be discussed at an initial community meeting and student leaders should confront irresponsible behavior and monitor floor decorations throughout the year.
- Refer to the Residence Life Handbook for up-to-date information on what is not permitted.

Fire Evacuation

RA RESPONSE PROCEDURES

- Leave the building and follow instructions from Public Safety, the Fire Department or other officials.

Bias Incidents

For the Bias Incident description & policy, refer to the Bias Reporting website:

<https://www.stthomas.edu/deanofstudents/bias-reporting/>

If you observe an incident of potential bias, **assume it is a bias incident** and **immediately** contact Public Safety. After you contact Public Safety, notify the CD/GSA on duty. CD/GSA on duty will contact the Associate Director of Residence Life. **The physical evidence of the bias should not be disturbed or erased prior to the arrival of Public Safety.**

No matter how small or minor the act may appear to you, if it pertains to identity, contact Public Safety immediately. **Although you may not find the act offensive or biased in nature, you cannot predict the responses of other members of the community.** Always document the situation via an incident report.

Severe Weather

Tornados and Severe Thunderstorms

- Public Safety will contact the CD/GSA On Duty in the event of a severe weather watch or warning.
 - The CD/GSA On Duty should put the information in the Res Life Staff GroupMe.
 - The CD/GSA On Duty will inform all RAs on duty by texting the duty phones.
 - Keep all team members informed of any updates from Public Safety.
- When a civil defense siren sounds, clear floors and move to the lower level or other designated areas in each residence hall, which are listed below. Please do this no matter what the weather “looks like.”
- If possible, listen to WCCO 830 AM radio, local television station, or a reliable weather app for status reports on severe weather.
- All floors should be evacuated to protect the welfare of the students. High winds can easily shatter glass and cause harm. BE SAFE!
- Stay in the safe areas until the siren is switched off. Keep in mind that the siren may sound before the tornado looks like it’s on top of us. Even so, follow evacuation procedures.

RA RESPONSE PROCEDURES

Evacuation Areas for Tornado or High Winds

BRADY	lower level
DOWLING	all lower level areas
FLYNN	parking ramp
FREY	lower level of Parking Garage
GRACE	general area of lower level, stay away from windows, lay face down
IRELAND	lower level wings, stay away from windows and lay face down
MID-CAMPUS	lower level, interior hallway
MORRISON	parking ramp, stairwells only if necessary
MURRAY	lower level – close to center as possible
TOMMIE NORTH	Parking garage

Use of Sequential or Master Keys

The University of St. Thomas Residence Life Office is committed to preserving the privacy of the residents of the halls. Student leaders **may not** enter a student's room without the explicit permission of at least one resident of that room, with the following exceptions:

- Emergency situations such as a rule violation in progress, life threatening conditions, etc.
- If noise (constantly ringing telephone, alarm clock, etc.) is coming from a room where no one is apparently present. If you decide to enter an apparently empty room to stop a noise problem, you must first:
 - Attempt to locate a resident of that room.
 - Confirm with your supervisor (or CD/GSA on call) prior to entering a space.
 - **You must have another student leader or staff member** accompany you when you enter the room. This protects you and the University from being held liable in a situation where a disgruntled resident could allege that you entered the room illegally or took illegal action while in the room.
 - Knock loudly on the door and identify yourself before entering the room. If the knock is not answered in a reasonable amount of time, knock again and announce that you are keying in. Open the door part way and then identify yourself before continuing into the room.
 - After keying into a student's room, send a follow up email including the reason for entering. CC your supervisor in this communication. (This is not applicable for mass room entries, such as routine health and safety inspections.)
- Room entry for the purpose of conducting routine, scheduled inspections such as preparation for vacation or break periods. These safety inspections are generally completed by two Student Leaders.

Student leaders are allowed access to a master key for use in emergency situations only. Use your access judiciously and carefully. Keep the following guidelines in mind:

- RAs are not permitted to key into a room without CD/GSA permission.
- Never loan out a master key. **Always** unlock the door yourself.
- Keep your access key in a secure location.

RA RESPONSE PROCEDURES

- Do not open a room for a non-resident of that room. If a non-resident wants to get into someone else's room, they must wait until the resident of that room returns. You can refer them to CD/GSA or Public Safety for further questions.
- Do not open a room for a resident whom you do not know without verifying (picture ID verified against Residence Life roster or Roomcompact) that they are the actual occupant.
- *See the Resident Student Handbook section on Room Entry and Room Search for more information.* Consult with the CD/GSA on duty, your CD/GSA, or another professional staff member prior to entry.
- Notify your CD/GSA **IMMEDIATELY** if you lose the master key or sequential key.

All RAs are allowed access to a master key. In buildings with card access, RA's student IDs serve as their master key. In communities where physical keys are still in use, each RA is issued an individually numbered access key that fits one of two locks on the sequential lock. The other lock holds the master key. Your CD/GSA will show you the location of this lock and how to access it.

If an RA temporarily loses or temporarily misplaces their ID card with master access, they will immediately call the CD/GSA on duty. If an RA loses their key or ID card (without master access), they will notify their CD/GSA immediately via email.

RAs are financially responsible for the replacement of any keys/access cards they are in possession of or check out. RAs are also responsible for all of the cores in which they access if a key/access card is lost.

Lost Keys

If a resident has lost their key:

- Instruct the student to go to the Residence Life Office in Koch 120 to report their missing key (they will be charged accordingly).
- Residence Life can also check out a spare key.

If a resident has lost their ID card:

- Instruct the individual to go to the card office (Monday – Friday, 8:30 am – 4:00 pm).
- If it is outside of office hours, instruct the student to go to Public Safety.

Lock Outs

- If a student is locked out of their room, they should look for an RA or CD/GSA to be let into their room.
- If residents cannot find an RA or the CD/GSA, they can go to the Residence Life Office (Koch 120). There will be limited staff to assist with lockouts in the Residence Life Office.

Tips for Writing a Good Incident Report

Tips for Writing a Good Incident Report

When you submit an Incident Report (IR), it becomes part of a formal, written record for the Office of Residence Life, the Dean of Students Office and the University as a whole. It can be requested for review by University staff as well as the student and their representatives. Therefore, please be sure to consider the following:

- Do not include your opinions about a resident or their behavior. Report just the **facts**.
 - Example - Opinion: The resident was non-compliant.
 - Example - Facts/Observations: Resident [Last Name] raised their voice with Public Safety Officers and repeatedly refused to sit down after multiple directives.
- Include **all relevant** facts about the incident - how you became aware of the situation, information about all involved parties, facts about the violation or situation. Be as objective and thorough as possible, and start off every incident report with the date/time. The IR should read as a moment-by-moment description of what occurred.
- When possible, use exact quotes from residents involved (especially when they are yelling, swearing, etc.).
- Write in the third-person voice. Instead of saying I/me, refer to yourself as RA Last Name (Example: RA Anderson or RA Jones). To avoid confusion about which person the report is referring to, try not to use pronouns for others and instead refer to them as Resident Last Name or Officer Last Name.
- If you realize you left something out after submitting the IR, misidentified someone or included anything else that needs to be corrected, **let your CD/GSA know as soon as possible**. If you can't confirm what you wrote - don't write it! Write the IR considering others will read it. Proof read for content as well as accuracy.
- **Check spelling, grammar, and sentence structure** - the basics you would correct on a paper. It is best to type the report in a word document first and copy/paste the narrative into Advocate.
- When Public Safety is involved, take down the last name of all officers involved and the report number. If you miss some information, you should ask the PS officers to fill in those missing details.
- You should submit this report as soon as possible and **definitely before you go to bed for the night. Do not wait until morning to submit it.**

- If you have notes with ID numbers and other sensitive information, give them to your CD/GSA and they will shred that information
- You will be submitting your incident reports on a website called Advocate. [The link can be found here. \(https://stthomas-advocate.symplicity.com/index.php/pid746599?s=home&mode=list&tab=list&tabmode=list\)](https://stthomas-advocate.symplicity.com/index.php/pid746599?s=home&mode=list&tab=list&tabmode=list) It is a good idea to save it as a bookmark on your computer.

Common IR Writing Mistakes:

Correct:

Smelled

Public Safety

Marijuana or THC

Residents/Students

Intoxicated

Residence Hall

Description of actions

Incorrect:

Smelt

Pub Safe

Weed

Residence

Drunk

Dorm

Summary/judgement of actions

Student Leader Nights Away from Campus

Your CD/GSA will determine the process to approve Student Leaders' nights away from campus. Nights must be requested and approved in advance. The department defines a night away from campus as being outside their Residence Hall or Residential Building past 2:30 am. Student Leaders may request up to six nights away per semester/J-Term.

Fall & Spring Semesters

Minimal days away during the first six weeks of the fall semester will be approved. There are required events including homecoming weekend and family weekend.

J-Term

Like Fall & Spring Semesters, RAs are allowed to take up to six nights away during J-Term, with the understanding that duty needs to be covered and that nights away may impact J-term meal plan.

RESIDENCE LIFE STUDENT PRINTING POLICY

As a residence life student leader, you have access to be able to print to a departmental index code when the Papercut print tracking system is activated. This allows you to print residence life related items and not be charged personally for the printing costs. You should not print any personal or schoolwork related items to a residence life index account. Before you print, please double check to make sure that you are printing to the appropriate account (the default should be your personal account).

If you have any questions about printing, please clarify with your CD/GSA.